

Workplace Conduct Policy

Syed Motors · Document Code: POL-05 · Type: workplace_conduct · Department: All Employees

Purpose

This policy establishes expectations for a respectful workplace, prohibits harassment, explains grievance escalation channels, and protects people who raise concerns or participate in an inquiry.

The policy applies to interactions involving employees, customers and vendors. It is intended to support a workplace in which concerns are taken seriously and addressed through documented company channels.

The policy is effective from the first working day of the current calendar year. It is reviewed annually by the document owner and revised as necessary. Version 1.0.

1. Anti-Harassment

Syed Motors has zero tolerance for harassment of any kind, including verbal, physical, sexual, or harassment based on gender, religion, ethnicity, or disability.

Every complaint is treated seriously and investigated by the Harassment Inquiry Committee within seven working days. Employees should use the available grievance channels when they experience or become aware of conduct that may require review.

Workplace expectations

Employees should maintain professional conduct in everyday interactions and should not treat offensive or harmful behaviour as acceptable simply because it occurs during a busy work period or in an informal setting.

A concern should be raised through an approved channel so that it can be handled by the responsible company process. Employees should avoid spreading complaint details through informal conversations.

Workplace Conduct Policy — Anti-Harassment and Respect

1. Anti-Harassment

Coverage of the prohibition

The policy covers verbal, physical and sexual harassment, as well as harassment based on gender, religion, ethnicity or disability. The stated zero-tolerance position means that employees should not dismiss a concern because the conduct was presented as a joke, personal disagreement or ordinary workplace pressure.

Employees who observe potentially inappropriate behaviour should use an approved escalation channel rather than attempting to conduct an informal investigation themselves. The formal inquiry process is handled by the Harassment Inquiry Committee.

Complaint handling

Every complaint is treated seriously and investigated by the Harassment Inquiry Committee within seven working days. The seven-working-day period is the stated investigation requirement in this policy.

A person raising a concern should provide the information requested through the relevant company process and should avoid altering or exaggerating the account. A person receiving a complaint should direct it through the appropriate channel rather than promising an outcome independently.

2. Respect at Work

Employees must treat colleagues, customers and vendors with courtesy. Raised voices, personal insults, and abusive language on the shop floor or with a customer will result in an immediate written warning.

Professional interaction

Courtesy applies across roles and levels of responsibility. Employees should communicate disagreements without personal insults, abusive language or aggressive behaviour. The requirement also applies when speaking with customers and vendors.

The shop floor is a working environment in which communication can affect safety, service and team coordination. Employees should therefore maintain professional language and tone even when a task is delayed or a customer interaction becomes difficult.

Workplace Conduct Policy — Respect and Escalation

2. Respect at Work

Customer and vendor interactions

Courtesy is required when dealing with customers and vendors. Employees should address concerns through the appropriate work process rather than responding with raised voices, personal insults or abusive language.

The policy states that raised voices, personal insults and abusive language on the shop floor or with a customer result in an immediate written warning. Employees should treat this rule as applying to workplace communication even when the disagreement concerns a legitimate business issue.

Handling disagreements

A disagreement about a task, schedule, customer request or workplace decision should be raised respectfully. Employees may seek supervisory support when a matter cannot be resolved through normal communication.

Respectful conduct does not require employees to ignore a concern. It requires that the concern be raised through appropriate language and the available escalation channels.

3. Escalation Channels

Grievances may be raised with the direct supervisor first. If unresolved, or if the supervisor is the subject of the complaint, employees may escalate to HR, then to the Branch Manager, and then to the anonymous ethics hotline at ethics@sarmadmotors.pk.

Escalation sequence

The direct supervisor is the first channel where that route is appropriate. If the grievance remains unresolved, the employee may escalate to HR. When the direct supervisor is the subject of the complaint, the employee may bypass that person and raise the matter through HR.

The Branch Manager is the next listed escalation level. The policy also identifies the anonymous ethics hotline as a further channel. Employees should use the route that fits the circumstances and the sequence stated in the policy.

Record of a grievance

Employees should provide clear and relevant information when raising a grievance. A formal channel helps ensure that the concern can be directed to the appropriate responsible person and that the escalation history is clear.

Workplace Conduct Policy — Retaliation Protection

4. Retaliation

Retaliating against a complainant, witness or investigator is itself a terminable offence. Retaliation includes negative assignments, reduced hours, exclusion from meetings, or negative review comments correlated to the complaint.

Protected participants

The protection applies to people who raise a complaint, people who provide information as witnesses, and people who participate in an investigation. Employees should not treat participation in a workplace inquiry as a reason to punish, isolate or disadvantage another person.

The policy identifies several examples of retaliation: negative assignments, reduced hours, exclusion from meetings, and negative review comments correlated to the complaint. These examples should be considered when evaluating changes in workplace treatment after a grievance is raised.

Workplace decisions after a complaint

Normal management decisions may still be required after a complaint, but employees and managers should ensure that decisions are handled through legitimate work considerations and not used as punishment for raising or supporting a complaint.

Where a person believes that retaliation may have occurred, the concern should be raised through the available escalation channels. The policy treats retaliation itself as a terminable offence.

Good-faith participation

Employees should provide relevant information honestly when participating in a grievance or inquiry. The purpose of the process is to allow the responsible company body to review the matter through the appropriate channel.

3. Escalation Channels

An employee may begin with the direct supervisor when appropriate. If the supervisor is involved in the complaint or the grievance remains unresolved, HR is the next listed channel, followed by the Branch Manager and then the anonymous ethics hotline.

Employees should avoid discussing sensitive complaint details widely or using informal communication as a replacement for the formal escalation route.

Workplace Conduct Policy — Responsibilities and Ownership

Employee Responsibilities

All employees are responsible for treating colleagues, customers and vendors with courtesy and for avoiding harassment, personal insults, raised voices and abusive language. Employees should use the formal grievance channels when they need to report a concern.

Employees who raise a complaint, act as witnesses or participate in an inquiry must not be subjected to retaliation. Concerns about possible retaliation should be raised through the approved escalation channels.

Conduct reference checklist

Harassment: the policy has zero tolerance for verbal, physical, sexual, gender-based, religion-based, ethnicity-based or disability-based harassment.

Inquiry: every complaint is treated seriously and investigated by the Harassment Inquiry Committee within seven working days.

Respect: employees must treat colleagues, customers and vendors with courtesy. Raised voices, personal insults and abusive language on the shop floor or with a customer result in an immediate written warning.

Escalation: direct supervisor first where appropriate, then HR, Branch Manager, and the anonymous ethics hotline at ethics@sarmadmotors.pk.

Retaliation: retaliation against a complainant, witness or investigator is a terminable offence. Examples include negative assignments, reduced hours, exclusion from meetings and negative review comments correlated to the complaint.

Approval and Ownership

This document is owned by the HR department and approved by the Branch Manager. Questions or clarifications should be directed to the document owner.

Non-compliance is a disciplinary matter under the HR Policy Manual. The document owner is responsible for the annual review and revision of this controlled policy.

Final workplace reminder

A respectful workplace depends on daily conduct and on using the available reporting channels when a concern arises. Employees should raise issues through the appropriate process, provide relevant information, and avoid retaliatory conduct against anyone involved in a complaint or inquiry.